

Mahesh M. Dhole

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Curriculum Vitae — July 2026

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, Southern Illinois University Carbondale	2022–present
Expected graduation: May 2027. Committee chair: Kevin Sylwester.	
M.A. in Economics, Madurai Kamaraj University, Tamil Nadu, India	2017
B.E. in Civil Engineering, K.D.K. College of Engineering, Nagpur, India	2009

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Labor Economics, Automation and Technological Change, Development Economics, Monetary Theory

JOB MARKET PAPER

“Does a High Minimum Wage Insulate or Expose Workers to the Effects of Technological Change? Evidence from U.S. States”

This paper examines whether state minimum wage increases change how technological change affects employment and wages in the United States. Using occupation-level automation exposure measures from Webb (2020) and exploiting cross-state variation in minimum wages from 1980 to 2010, I find that higher minimum wages magnify both the employment and wage losses associated with software exposure: software-exposed occupations fared worse in states where minimum wages increased the most. The pattern differs for industrial robots. I find no comparable employment effect, but wages decline more in robot-exposed occupations where minimum wages rose more, with a wage interaction about twice the magnitude of the software estimate. Taken together, the results indicate that minimum wages do not interact uniformly with automation: wage floors amplify broad employment and wage adjustment under software exposure but mainly wage adjustment under robots. Minimum wage policy alone therefore appears insufficient to shield workers from technological change, and its labor-market effects depend on the form of automation to which workers are exposed.

WORKING PAPERS

“Taxing Automation’s Bite: State Corporate Taxes and the Labor Market Consequences of Robot and Software Exposure”

Examines whether state corporate tax regimes moderate the labor market consequences of automation exposure over 1980–2010. Higher corporate taxes modestly accelerate employment losses in automation-exposed occupations, with a near-zero wage interaction consistent with a composition channel.

“Unequal Machines: Automation Inequality by Race and Gender in the United States”

Estimates the employment and wage effects of robot and software exposure separately by race and gender using Webb (2020) measures and IPUMS USA microdata. Software exposure produces symmetric wage losses and no employment effects across groups; industrial robots displace African American and female workers while expanding male employment, with women facing roughly double the robot-induced wage loss of men.

WORK IN PROGRESS

“The Composition of State Taxation and Business Dynamism: Evidence from U.S. Firm Entry and Job Flows, 1978–2022” (with Yaren Gocer and Syeda Jahirin)

Asks whether the composition of state taxation—capital versus labor—affects firm entry and job creation, linking a 45-year state tax panel to the Census Bureau’s Business Dynamics Statistics across state, sector, and county designs with wild-cluster bootstrap and event-study inference.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, Southern Illinois University Carbondale

History and Philosophy of the World’s Economic Systems (ECON 302i, online) Summers 2025, 2026

Overall course evaluation 4.46/5.0; instructor effectiveness 4.56/5.0 (Summer 2025).

Teaching Assistant, Southern Illinois University Carbondale

Microeconomics II (Graduate) Spring 2026

Mathematical Economics	Fall 2024, Fall 2025
Econometrics I (Graduate)	Spring 2025
Macroeconomics II (Graduate)	Spring 2024
Introduction to Macroeconomics	Fall 2023
Intermediate Macroeconomics	Spring 2023
Data Science II	Fall 2022
Research Assistant for Prof. Aparajita Dasgupta, Ashoka University, India	Mar–May 2022
CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS	
Midwest Economic Association (MEA) 83rd Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL	2026
Southern Economic Association (SEA) 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL	2025
Illinois Economic Association (IEA) 54th Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL	2025
Fall Brown Bag Seminar, SIU Carbondale, Carbondale, IL	2025
Data-Intensive Research Conference, Minneapolis, MN	2025
FELLOWSHIPS, HONORS, AND AWARDS	
Dissertation Research Assistantship Award, Southern Illinois University Carbondale	2026–2027
PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	
Project Manager , NeRomer Corporation, India	2013–2021
Project Officer , Adani Power Maharashtra Ltd., India	2011–2012
CERTIFICATIONS	
FRED Data Practitioner: Micro Credentials & Badging	2024
Essential Tools in Optimization	2020
Optimization & Statistical Models & Tools (OSMT-2020)	2020
International Conference on Recent Trends in Mathematics & its Applications to Graph, Networks & Petri Nets (ICRTMA-GPN-2020)	2020
UNIVERSITY SERVICE	
President, Economics Student Association (ESA), SIUC	2024–2026
Member, Economics Student Association (ESA), SIUC	2023–2024
SKILLS	
Software: Stata, R, Python, E-Views	
Applications: L ^A T _E X, Zotero, Microsoft Office Suite, Advanced Excel	
Languages: Marathi (native), Hindi and English (fluent)	
CITIZENSHIP	
India	
REFERENCES	
Kevin Sylwester (chair) — Department of Economics, Southern Illinois University	ksylwest@siu.edu, +1 (618) 453-5075
Alison Watts — Department of Economics, Southern Illinois University	wattsa@siu.edu, +1 (618) 453-5073
Scott Gilbert — Department of Economics, Southern Illinois University	gilberts@siu.edu, +1 (618) 453-5095